

Palau International Ship Registry



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MARINE CIRCULAR 191.1

To: ALL SHIPOWNERS, MANAGERS, MASTERS, AND REGISTRATION OFFICERS OF MERCHANT SHIPS AND RECOGNIZED ORGANIZATIONS.

Subject: SPECIAL MEASURES CONCERNING THE MAXIMUM PERIOD OF SHIPBOARD SERVICE FOR SEAFARERS DURING THE COVID-19 PANDEMIC

1. In view of the current situation due to Coronavirus (Covid-19) outbreak, and bearing in mind that seafarers are “key workers” providing an essential service, the ship management companies are kindly requested to plan more carefully than before in order to ensure that any crew change can be conducted.

In cases where the continuous period of shipboard service needs to exceed 12 months due to inevitable reasons, it is strongly recommended that an extension of the contract period is signed by both parties and approved by Palau International Ship Registry (PISR), a practical and expeditious plan of repatriation is agreed, and any other relevant documents are prepared to be shown.

2. In the light of International Maritime Organization Circular Letter Circular Letter No.4204/Add.30 dated on 11 September 2020, PISR, taking into consideration the difficulties to the exchange of crew members already on board Palau flagged Ships, sets the following temporary measures:

Maximum period of shipboard service for seafarers during the covid-19 pandemic:

- ✓ Where a seafarer has a valid seafarer employment agreement (SEA), which is signed by all parties and is being complied with, and has served on board a vessel for less than 11 months without taking a leave, no action is taken;
- ✓ Where a seafarer has a valid SEA and has served continuously on board a vessel for more than 11 months, without taking a leave, the master will be required to provide a plan for the seafarer's repatriation which shall be approved by PISR, and results in the repatriation of the seafarer before he (she) has served a maximum continuous period of 14 months.
- ✓ No extensions of service, without taking a leave, beyond 14 months will be accepted by PISR unless the master or owner or both demonstrate satisfactorily to PISR that all possible efforts have been expended to repatriate the seafarer without success and the seafarer has provided written confirmation accepting the extension.
- ✓ Where a seafarer does not have a valid SEA, the master will be required to arrange repatriation of the seafarer. This may require accommodating the seafarer ashore until repatriation can be arranged. If the departure of the seafarer means that the vessel's minimum safe manning requirements cannot be met, the vessel may be prohibited from departing port. However, the vessel may be allowed to move to another berth within the port or conduct port operations.



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3. In any case, when an extension of an 11 months maximum period of shipboard service for seafarers is required during the covid-19 pandemic,
- ✓ an application shall be submitted to PISR, with accompanying documents as defined in above paragraphs,
 - ✓ a written consent shall be given to the master of the ship by the seafarer(s) in reference, and
 - ✓ a dispensation shall be granted by PISR bearing in mind all the circumstances of the specific case.

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ANNEX

To Whom It May Concern:

RE: 1. Application received from ship-owners

2. MSMC with number

3. Crew List: issued on

**This letter is issued under the authority of the Government of the
REPUBLIC OF PALAU.**

Particulars of the Ship	
Name of the Ship:	
IMO number:	
Port of Registry:	
Call Sign:	
GRT:	

Due to exceptional circumstances, and bearing in mind:

- The significant challenges being faced by the global shipping industry to effect crew changes as a result of the coronavirus (COVID-19) outbreak,
- The extensive travel restrictions between infected and non-infected countries by COVID-19,
- The importance to ensure that safe crew changes take place,
- The Company's written request for an exception to Standards A2.14 (g) "Termination of an Employment Agreement" and A2.4.3 "Entitlement to leave",

A dispensation is granted toin order to extend the Seafarer Employment Agreement referring to

1.
2.
3.



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Conditions for dispensation:

- A written consent is given to the master of the ship by the seafarer(s) in reference;
- When crew change commences, those seafarers who have been on-board the longest will be prioritized and repatriated first regardless of rank;
- The shipping company will take measures for ensuring safety, crew health, welfare, and prevention of fatigue, and where possible, provide seafarers with extra bandwidth and internet access to be able to communicate with home;

Validity Period of Dispensation:

This letter is valid until:, subject to reconsideration according to the ongoing COVID-19 restrictions.

